

of Information and Communications Technology (UN-OICT) to launch the ‘Open Source Data Centre Challenge’. This project aims to develop open source solutions for creating a carbon-negative data centre model.



Data centres, responsible for around 3-4% of global carbon emissions, have a larger carbon footprint than aviation, as per 2022 data. The initiative, known as ‘Patchwork Kilt’, will bring together a diverse community to tackle this issue. Participants in the challenge will contribute to areas

such as heat redirection, building repurposing, heat reuse, circular supply chain management, blueprint evolution, and community empowerment.

Christ Lloyd-Jones, OpenUK’s chief blueprint officer, said, “Our collaboration creates a challenge to open this initiative to contributions and a broader community, allowing new technologies to be included. It’s a critical initiative that can impact data centre sustainability.”

Salem Avan, UN director of policy, strategy, and governance, highlighted open source’s importance, stating, “It fuels innovation, transparency, and cost-efficiency. By using open source technology to run data centres efficiently, we reduce our environmental footprint and contribute to global sustainability.”

The winning contributor will receive a trophy and attend OpenUK’s Awards Ceremony in November.

Vulnerabilities in Curl raise concerns

Maintainers of a widely-used open source tool, essential for supporting network protocols such as SSL, TLS, HTTP, FTP, and SMTP, have cautioned users about two upcoming vulnerabilities. Curl, a command-line utility for API interaction and file downloads, faces one high-severity issue (CVE-2023-38545) and a lower-severity problem (CVE-2023-38546).

While CVE-2023-38545 affects both Curl and its underlying library, libcurl, CVE-2023-38546 exclusively affects libcurl. An update released on October 11 addressed both issues.

Maintainers have been cautious about disclosing specific version details, emphasising the need to avoid premature exploitation.

Melissa Bischooping, director of endpoint security research at Tanium, highlighted the widespread use of Curl. She advised organisations to take heed and assess their systems in light of these vulnerabilities, even though the full impact remains uncertain.

Warehouse: A new tool for easier Flatpak management

Flatpak enthusiasts can now rejoice as a user-friendly tool named ‘Warehouse’ will simplify the management of Flatpak apps and remotes. This GTK4/libadwaita-powered tool bridges the gap between Flatpak’s command-line interface and user convenience.

Warehouse offers a quick overview of installed Flatpak apps and runtimes, with an option to reveal hidden runtimes. It matches the detail of the ‘flatpak list’ command but in a user-friendly GUI, providing buttons for convenient clipboard copying.

VLC unveils version 3.0.19

VLC, the renowned open source media player, has unveiled version 3.0.19, delivering substantial upgrades along with critical bug fixes. However, there’s a caveat — the most significant improvements are exclusively reserved for Windows users.

VLC 3.0.19 introduces super resolution scaling for compatible Nvidia and Intel GPUs. This AI-assisted upscaling is best suited for lower-resolution videos, albeit not a game-changer for high-definition content. Windows users can enable this feature via VLC’s *Advanced Settings > Output Modules* section. The update also bestows AV1 hardware decoding on Windows, a notable enhancement for video playback.

The positive news is that all platforms, including Linux, benefit from improved software decoding for AV1 HDR content.

The update also addresses several issues and enhances various functionalities. These include improvements in FFmpeg-muxed MP4 chapter control, AAC handling, playback of QNap-produced AVI files, and the surprising comeback of support for very old RealVideo format files. Additional adjustments cover rendering issues on Linux when using the VLC full screen controller and enhanced subtitle clarity for macOS users.

VLC 3.0.19 claims to rectify YouTube playback issues, provide better file handling during read-only mode, and offer improved CrunchyRoll SSA rendering.

Although VLC 3.0.19 has not yet been officially announced on the Videolan website, the source code is accessible, and installers for Windows and macOS are available. Linux users will need to wait for their turn to access these new features.